SPEAK TO TRAVEL

EXPRESS: 1-Month Conversation Boost

Teacher's book: the short version of **File 1 (3-Month Program)**. **Students:** Portuguese speakers who **already know English** (they read it, understand a lot, studied grammar) but are **bad at conversation**: they freeze, speak slowly, translate in their heads, can't follow fast speech, or give one-word answers. **Duration:** 4 weeks · 3 sessions per week · 60 minutes = **12 sessions**. **Rule of this program:** the student talks **80%** of the time. There's very little new content and a lot of speaking.

TEACHER'S BOOK

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Uses the same companion files:

- **File 3 (Error Guide)**: error guide (pronunciation, false friends, translated sentences)
- **File 4 (Question Bank)**: role-play question bank
- **File 5 (Student Sheets)**: diagnostic form, "My Story" card, emergency card, certificate

01 Who this is for (and who it's NOT for)

GOOD FIT (USE THE 6-QUESTION DIAGNOSTIC IN SECTION 3)

- Answers basic questions (name, work, family) without much trouble
- Understands slow English well, but gets lost at native speed
- Knows the past tense "on paper" but doesn't use it when speaking
- Says things like: *"Eu entendo tudo, mas na hora de falar trava."* ("I understand everything, but when it's time to speak I freeze.")

NOT A GOOD FIT, SO OFFER THE 12-WEEK PROGRAM INSTEAD

- Can't answer "What do you do?" or "Tell me about your family"
- Needs most questions repeated in Portuguese

Be honest about this in the first meeting. A weak student in a fast program gets frustrated and quits, and that hurts your reputation.

THE PROMISE

> "In 4 weeks you'll go from 'I understand but I can't speak' to holding a real 10-minute conversation, at normal speed, without freezing. You'll handle any travel situation and an interview with confidence."

THE HONEST LIMIT

one month won't fix every grammar mistake or change the accent. It fixes the **speaking block**, which is usually the student's real problem.

02 What's different from the 12-week program

	12 weeks	
Starting level	Knows a little English	**Knows English, can't speak it**
Main problem attacked	Lack of phrases + fear	**Blocking, slowness, translating, listening speed**
New content	Lots of phrases per week	**Few phrases. Practice using what they already know**
Travel situations	1 per week	**All in one week (W2), at native speed**
Student talking time	70%	**80%**
Correction	Gentle	**More direct. They can take it**
Homework	15 min/day	**20 min/day, all of it speaking**

03 Session 0: diagnostic (before day 1)

30 minutes, free. Use the form in **File 5 (Student Sheets)**, but go harder:

1. **Goals (in Portuguese):** Trip? Interview? Work? Date? What happens when you try to speak?
2. **Speaking (record it):**
   - Tell me about yourself. *(Ask for 2 minutes. Most will stop after 20 seconds, and that tells you a lot.)*
   - What did you do last weekend? Tell me everything.
   - Describe your city to someone who's never been there.
   - What's better: traveling alone or with family? Why?
   - What would you do if your flight was canceled?
   - Tell me about a difficult moment in your life or work.
3. **Listening at native speed:** play 1 minute of a real conversation (a podcast or a TV interview, not a learner video). Ask 3 questions.
4. **Measure:** how many seconds before they start answering? Do they give one-word answers? Do they ask you anything back?

Score with the rubric in section 7. **Keep the recording.** You'll play it in Session 12.

04 The 60-minute Express session

Time	Block	What happens
0–5	**Warm-up**	Real small talk at **normal speed**. No slowing down.
5–15	**Fluency drill**	One of the 5 fluency tools (section 5), usually the 4–3–2.
15–20	**Toolbox**	5–8 phrases or "conversation moves" for today. Quick, no long explanations.
20–45	**Role-plays / discussion**	Long, unscripted, with surprises. Teacher plays natives at natural speed.
45–55	**Error clinic**	Show the 5 mistakes you noted. Student corrects them **out loud**. Then repeat a piece of the role-play correctly.
55–60	**Homework + 1 specific win**	Send it on WhatsApp right after class.

Correction style: during the role-play, don't stop the student. Write the mistakes down. In the error clinic, write each mistake as the student said it and ask *"What's wrong here?"* Students at this level can usually fix it themselves, and fixing it themselves is what makes it stick.

05 The 5 fluency tools

These are the core of the Express program. Use one or two in every session.

Tool 1 — 4-3-2

The student talks about one topic for **4 minutes**. Then the **same topic for 3 minutes**, then again for **2 minutes**. Each round they say the same content faster and more smoothly. It's a well-known fluency exercise, and the student can feel the improvement in a single session.

Tool 2 — Buy time (fillers)

Brazilians go silent when they're thinking, and in English a long silence feels uncomfortable. Teach natural "thinking sounds":

- *Well… / Let me think… / That's a good question… / How can I put this… / I mean… / You know… / Actually…*
- Ban "é…" and "tipo…" in class. The student pays 1 point every time they use one.

Tool 3 — Paraphrase (when the word is missing)

Don't stop the conversation because you don't know one word. Go around it:

- *It's a kind of… / It's something you use to… / It's like a… but… / I don't know the word, but it's the thing that…*
- **Game, "Forbidden Word":** describe an object (a word on a card) without saying it. The teacher guesses.

Tool 4 — Shadowing

Play 1 minute of real native speech. The student repeats **right behind the speaker**, about half a second later, copying the speed, the melody and the way words connect. This trains both listening and speaking at the same time.

Tool 5 — Follow-up questions (ask back)

Students who know English often answer well and then stop. Every answer should end with a question back:

- *And you? / What about you? / Have you ever…? / How was it? / Why did you…? / What was the best part?*
- **Rule in class:** any answer without a question back is "incomplete" (except in immigration interviews, where you answer short and don't ask back).

06 The 4 weeks, session by session

WEEK 1

UNBLOCK

I start speaking right away and I don't stop

WEEK 2

TRAVEL AT REAL SPEED

I handle every travel situation, even with surprises

WEEK 3

KEEP IT ALIVE

I can have a real back-and-forth conversation

WEEK 4

GO DEEPER + FINAL

I give opinions, tell stories, pass an interview

WEEK

01

WEEK 1 OF 4

UNBLOCK

SESSION 1

1 Fluency over perfection

- **Talk with the student (in Portuguese, 3 min):** in conversation, being understood matters more than being correct. Mistakes are allowed. Silence is the real problem.
- **Fluency drill:** 4–3–2 on *"Tell me about yourself."*
- **Toolbox:** fillers (Tool 2) + the survival phrases: *Sorry, could you repeat that? / What do you mean by…? / Could you say that in a different way?*
- **Role-play:** "Speed questions". The teacher fires 20 personal questions and the student must start answering in **under 3 seconds**.
- **Homework:** record a 2-minute voice message: "Tell me about yourself." Start the "My Story" card.

SESSION 2

2 When you don't know the word

- **Fluency drill:** 4–3–2 on *"Describe your city / your house."*
- **Toolbox:** paraphrasing (Tool 3).
- **Activities:** Forbidden Word game (10 cards). Then "Describe the picture": the student describes a busy photo in detail for 3 minutes.
- **Error clinic:** focus on the classic "translated" sentences from **File 3 (Error Guide)** that this student makes.
- **Homework:** "Talk to yourself" for 5 minutes a day: describe what you're doing in English while cooking or driving.

SESSION 3

3 Listening at native speed

- **Fluency drill:** shadowing (Tool 4) with a 1-minute dialogue.
- **Toolbox: connected speech**, meaning how natives really say it: *gonna, wanna, gotta, "whaddaya", "didja", "lemme", "kinda"*, and words that run together (*"turn_it_off", "pick_it_up"*).

- **Activity:** "Real-speed dictation". The teacher says 10 fast sentences and the student writes them, then says them at the same speed.
- **Free talk (15 min):** what are your goals for this month? What was hardest this week?
- **Self-check** (fichas, sheet 3). Record a short audio sample for comparison.

WEEK

02

WEEK 2 OF 4

TRAVEL AT REAL SPEED

The student "knows" travel English already. This week is about doing it **fast, with surprises**, and without the phrase sheet. Use **File 4 (Question Bank)**.

4

SESSION 4

Airport + immigration

- **Warm-up:** quick review of the polite requests *Could I... / I'd like... / Would it be possible...* (instead of *"I want..."*).
- **Role-plays:** check-in → security (fast commands) → **immigration** with the 3 officer types: friendly, neutral-fast and serious (bank section 1).
- **Immigration rules (say them in Portuguese):** short, true, direct answers. Answer only what was asked. Don't fill silences.
- **Surprise:** flight canceled → rebooking at the counter.
- **Homework:** prepare **your own true answers** to the 10 most common immigration questions. Record them as audio.

5

SESSION 5

Hotel + restaurant + shopping

- **Fluency drill:** shadowing a real fast barista / waiter dialogue.
- **Toolbox:** polite complaints: *I'm sorry to bother you, but... / I think there's a mistake... / Would it be possible to...?*
- **Role-plays (with problem cards):** hotel check-in → wrong room → restaurant with a fast waiter → wrong dish → split the check and tip → return an item at a store.
- **Culture:** in the US, a 15–20% tip is expected, and sales tax is added when you pay.
- **Homework:** watch a real travel vlog in English (10 min, English subtitles) and write 5 phrases you'd use.

SESSION 6

6 Problems & emergencies + "Full Trip"

Role-plays: doctor (symptoms, medication, allergies), pharmacy, stolen bag / police report, lost luggage.

Big role-play (20 min): "Full Trip Simulation". Airport → immigration → Uber → hotel → restaurant → feeling sick → pharmacy. The teacher changes character every 3–4 minutes. No preparation and no phrase sheet.

Homework: make the Emergency Card (fichas, sheet 4). **Checkpoint:** score the Full Trip with the rubric.

WEEK 03

WEEK 3 OF 4

KEEP THE CONVERSATION ALIVE

7 SESSION 7 — Small talk that doesn't die

- **Fluency drill:** 4–3–2 on *"Your last trip."*
- **Toolbox:** follow-up questions (Tool 5) + reactions: *Oh really? / No way! / That's amazing! / Me too / Me neither / That makes sense.*
- **Small talk in 3 parts:** start (*Is this your first time here? / Beautiful day, isn't it?*), keep it going (follow-ups), finish (*It was great talking to you. Enjoy your trip!*).
- **Game, "Keep it alive":** the teacher gives short, boring answers. The student must keep the conversation going for 5 minutes.
- **Homework:** prepare 30-second answers to *"What's Brazil like? Is it safe? What should I eat there?"* Foreigners always ask these.

8 SESSION 8 — Telling stories

- **Fluency drill:** shadowing a short story from a podcast.
- **Toolbox:** story connectors: *So… / Then… / Suddenly… / Anyway… / The funny thing is… / Long story short…* Also the past-tense verbs they know but avoid: *went, got, took, saw, told, felt, bought, thought.*
- **Activity, "Photo stories":** the student brings 5 real photos from their phone and tells the story behind each one. The teacher interrupts with questions (*Wait, who was that? Then what happened?*).
- **Error clinic focus:** using the present when they mean the past (*"yesterday I go"*), and the final **–ED** pronunciation.
- **Homework:** record "The best (or worst) trip of my life" in 3 minutes.

9 SESSION 9 — Real conversation practice

- **This session is almost all free conversation (40 min)** on topics the student picks from a list: work, family, food, travel, movies or series, sports, city life vs. country life, technology, health,

dreams.

The teacher acts like a real conversation partner: shares their own opinions, interrupts naturally, changes the subject, makes jokes. Not "teacher mode".

Last 15 min: error clinic + self-check.

Optional real-world mission: before Session 12, the student talks with a real English speaker. That could be a friend of yours on a video call, a language-exchange app, or a tourist.

WEEK

04

WEEK 4 OF 4

GO DEEPER + FINAL

10 SESSION 10 — Opinions & discussion

- **Fluency drill:** 4–3–2 on *"Something you would change in your city."*
- **Toolbox:** *I think… / In my opinion… / I see your point, but… / I'm not so sure about that / It depends / On the other hand… / I'd rather…*
- **Mini-debates (the teacher takes the opposite side on purpose):** beach vs. mountains · cruise vs. road trip · big city vs. small town · is social media good or bad? · is it better to travel young or older?
- **Hypothetical:** *If I could live anywhere, I'd… / What would you do if…?*
- **Homework:** prepare a 2-minute talk: "My dream trip" or "A change I'd like to make in my life."

11 SESSION 11 — Interview day

- **Pick the interview the student actually needs:**
  - **Immigration/border:** the "serious officer" version, longer, with lots of follow-ups.
  - **Job interview in English:** *Tell me about yourself / Strengths and weaknesses / A difficult problem you solved (STAR: Situation, Task, Action, Result) / Do you have any questions for us?*(bank section 9)
  - **Social interview:** meeting a friend's family, a dinner party.
- **Run it twice.** Round 1, then feedback, then Round 2. Compare the two.
- **Homework:** do your preparation and get a good night's sleep. Tomorrow is the final.

12 SESSION 12 — Final assessment & graduation

1. **Final recorded conversation (25 min):** "Tell me about yourself" (2 min) → immigration interview (5 min) → a story (3 min) → opinion debate (5 min) → free conversation (10 min).
2. **Score with the rubric** and compare with the diagnostic.
3. **Play the diagnostic recording, then today's.**

4. **Certificate** (fichas, sheet 5. Change it to "Express: 12 sessions").
5. **"Keep going on your own" plan:** shadow 10 min a day, watch one series with English subtitles, have one conversation a week, re-read the My Story card.
6. **Offer the next step:** a monthly maintenance plan (for example, 1–2 classes a week) or more Express months with new topics. Ask for a testimonial and referrals.

07 Assessment

Use the same **6-area rubric (score 1–5, total /30)** from File 1, section 7: Fluency · Comprehension · Vocabulary · Accuracy · Pronunciation · Interaction.

Check at: Session 0 (diagnostic) → Session 6 (Full Trip checkpoint) → Session 12 (final).

Also measure these numbers. Students love seeing them improve:

Measure	Session 0	Session 12
"Tell me about yourself" before they stop (seconds)		
Seconds before they start answering		
Times they switched to Portuguese in 10 min		
Follow-up questions they asked in 5 min of small talk		

Typical journey for this level: about 14–17 at the diagnostic → about 19–23 at the final.

08 Daily homework (20 min)

All homework is **speaking**. Send it on WhatsApp after each class.

Every day	Task
5 min	**Shadowing** a 1-minute real audio clip (podcast, series, vlog)
5 min	**Talk to yourself** in English: describe your day or what you're doing
10 min	**Voice message to the teacher** on the topic of the week. The teacher replies with a short audio and 2–3 corrections.

The voice messages matter most. Hearing their own voice improve week after week is what keeps students motivated.

09 Selling the Express version

- **Who buys it:** people with a trip or interview coming soon, people who "studied English for years but can't speak", former students of English courses, professionals.
- **Package:** 12 sessions in 1 month, paid upfront. Charge a bit more per hour than the 12-week program (it's more intensive and needs more preparation), or the same per hour with no discount. **Check what other teachers in your area charge first.**

- **After the month:** offer a **monthly maintenance plan** (1–2 classes a week). That's where the steady income is.
- **Upgrade path:** someone who fails the Session 0 diagnostic → offer the 12-week program instead.
- **Pitch line:** *"Você já sabe inglês. Em um mês, você vai conseguir FALAR inglês."* ("You already know English. In one month, you'll be able to SPEAK English.")